

Bronte Harbour Classic Progress Meeting - February 4, 2026

Meeting Notes Organized by Topic

Attendees Present: Greg Kowalczyk, Yasmin, Patricia, Charles, Adriana, Jono
Attendees Absent: Liz, Ursula, Jocelyn, Myles, and others

1. VENUE & LAYOUT

Park Layout Planning

- Awaiting official map from Town of Oakville (expected this week)
- Team will draft individual layout ideas then collaborate on final design
- Power available throughout park - location matters
- Gazebo ("The Bronte") will serve as main information/base area and bag check

Event Zones

- **Performance Stage:** Near gazebo/sale area
- **Vendors Area:** Around performance stage, possibly in rows
- **Food Trucks:** Along path/sidewalk (not on grass to prevent damage) - 5 food trucks planned
- **Kids Area:** Jumping castles and games (vendor provides supervision & insurance)
- **Beer Garden:** Must be fenced, near music/sale area
- **Awards Presentation:** By the sale/gazebo

Specific Concerns

- Ground becomes moist in certain areas after rain - avoid for vendor placement
- Large stones in some areas affect flow
- Construction planned (water pump line) may affect route/water station placement

2. RACE ROUTE & LOGISTICS

5K Route

- **Start:** Park entrance area (exact location TBD pending map)

- Ontario Street → Marine Drive → Coronation Park → finish back at Bronte Harbour Park
- **Finish Line:** Set so participants enter park immediately after crossing
- Half of road will be closed for safety

1K Kids Race

- Planned along path away from main activities
- Timing TBD (discussion whether to do before or after main race)
- ~1km loop suggested: Start near park, path loop, return to finish area

Road Closures

- Roads closed until organizers instruct police to reopen
- Coronation Park area likely opens ~9:30 AM (Father's Day barbecue consideration)
- Main race starts 8:00 AM, last runner through Coronation ~9:00 AM
- Additional hour to remove barriers

3. VENDORS & EXHIBITORS

Food & Drink Vendors

- **Number:** 5 food trucks (2 initially proposed was too few)
- **Location:** Along sidewalk/path, not on grass
- **Requirements:**
 - Must be licensed and permitted by city
 - 10x10 spot
 - Provide own tent
 - Submit proof of insurance by ~1 month before event (May 17 suggested deadline)
 - Additional insurance for kids area vendors (jumping castles)

Vendor Fee & Process

- **Fee:** \$250 for 10x10 spot (discounted from typical \$500)
- **Application:** Google Form based on other event templates (Adriana creating)
- **Insurance:** Vendors provide certificate listing event under their insurer
- **Mix:** Aim for variety, not multiple of same type
- Local businesses prioritized

Sponsors & Special Guests

- Each sponsor gets booth spot if desired
- Town of Oakville likely to have booth
- Charity and special guest booths

4. VOLUNTEERS

Target Numbers

- **Goal:** Minimum 75 volunteers (aim to recruit double due to no-shows)
- **Oakfield Bats:** Meeting next week, hoping for 30-35 volunteers
- **Schools:** High school students seeking community service credits
- **St. John Ambulance:** Providing medical volunteers along route

Volunteer Provisions

- Food, shirts, training
- Sun protection (hats)
- Radio communication for key personnel

Volunteer Roles

- Handing out bibs, bananas, water
- Traffic control
- Water stations
- Cheering stations
- Course marshals
- Bag check/registration

5. REGISTRATION & MARKETING

Current Status

- **Current Registrations:** 80
- **February Goal:** 250 sign-ups by end of month
- **Total Target:** 800 participants

Marketing Strategies

- Cash prizes have significantly increased buzz and registrations
- Recruitment incentive: Runners who recruit 10 people get unique code for free entry
- Need more social media content - "Taping Tuesday" videos
- Plan to film course run in good weather to show route
- Handouts for downtown Bronte and Oakville

Social Media & Content

- Push for more consistent posting from all team members
- Use Sunday run videos
- Need influencer to help with shoe manufacturer partnerships
- Kelly (race series partner) wants photo with team members to start promotional posting

6. SPONSORSHIPS & BUDGET

Secured Sponsorship

- **CIBC:** \$5,000 as founding sponsor (committed)
- **Additional:** \$1,500-\$2,000 expected from another source

Open Sponsorships

- Title sponsorship still available
- All other sponsorship levels open
- Prices negotiable given tough financial climate
- 3-year packages available for cost savings

Budget Highlights

- **Largest Expense:** Police services (~\$10,000, may be lower if not all roads closed)
- **Event Liability Insurance:** \$5 million (covers whole event including noise, kids area per city)
- Many quotes coming in higher than initial estimates

7. RACE DAY OPERATIONS

Safety & Emergency

- Need comprehensive safety/emergency protocols
- Weather contingency plans (high temperature, wind could trigger cancellation)
- Greg K. as primary decision-maker with backup person
- Radio communication for instant contact between key personnel
- Traffic control plan required

Timing & Results

- Timing service already secured
- Need separate mat at start (~400m from finish) - additional cost
- Lily (timer) has some inflatable equipment available

Medical Support

- St. John Ambulance providing ambulance and volunteers
- Donation to St. John Ambulance included in budget

Water Stations

- Meeting with Radix tomorrow about water station & electrolytes
- One station planned at 2.5K mark (in parking lot for easy cleanup)
- Construction may force relocation

8. ENTERTAINMENT & ACTIVITIES

Music & Announcements

- **Sound Systems:** Two systems (one for start/finish, one for sale area)
- **Stage:** Location TBD based on final layout
- **Bands:**
 - Sound of Music (Burlington) contact can lend equipment and provide local bands
 - Louisa's daughter to play on route
 - Greg has band from Burlington
- **Race Announcer:** Contact from race director summit with "great voice"

Kids Activities

- Jumping castles (vendor supervised, additional insurance required)
- No entrance fee for kids activities

- 1K kids race
- Possible games area

Beer Garden

- Must be fenced area
- Located near music/stage
- Need bouncer/security (Matias suggested)

9. AWARDS & PRIZES

Prize Structure

- **Cash Prizes:** Top 3 male/female overall open runners
- **Shoe Prizes:** Hoping shoe manufacturer supplies shoes for overall & masters winners
- **Medals:** All other finishers
- **Halton's Big Three:** Special trophy for completing all 3 races (Moose in June, Bronte Harbour Classic, Canada Day race)
- Kelly working on special trophy
- Idea for interlocking medals

Awards Presentation

- Politicians/MPs to be involved (meeting with 2 MPs scheduled)
- Prize donors to hand out awards
- Likely by sale/gazebo area
- Race announcer to MC the presentation

10. RACE MERCHANDISE & MATERIALS

Items Needed

- **Race Shirts:** Discuss design with Brent
- **Finisher Medals:** Design needed, same supplier as current "really nice" medals
- **Swag Bags:** Mix of sponsor items and designed items
- **Bibs:** Distribution at registration
- **Branding:** Need arch/truss with banner at finish line for photos and publicity

11. PARTNERSHIPS & COMMUNITY OUTREACH

BIA Meetings

- **Bronte BIA:** Meeting February 17
- **Oakville Downtown BIA:** Contact through Nancy for 5K support

Running Clubs

- Patricia reaching out to hundreds of running clubs
- Some tension with Bronte Runners (members joined from other clubs)

Media Relations

- Need to pursue newspapers, TV, radio
- Consult Donna (she can connect but doesn't have capacity to own the task)

Charitable Partners

- Oakville Dads Community Fund (primary charity with donation link)
- Multiple charity booths possible (referencing Yorkville 5K model with 20 charities)

12. EQUIPMENT & INFRASTRUCTURE

Required Equipment

- Tents, barriers, porta-potties
- 28 washrooms calculated (1 per 75 participants, target 1,000 including visitors)
- 2 public washrooms in park
- Extra barriers for signage (check with city)
- Truss/arch for finish line branding
- Radios for communication
- Generator/power connections

Rentals

- Sound of Music contact can provide tents, structures, equipment
- Greg may have or rent truss
- Porta-potty rental needs to happen soon (World Cup consuming supply)

13. OUTSTANDING TASKS & DECISIONS

Immediate Actions (This Week)

- Receive park map from city
- Greg meeting with Radix about water station/hydration
- Create vendor application form (Adriana)
- Send email to get BIA contact (Greg)

To Be Determined

- Exact start/finish locations (pending map)
- Kids race timing and route details
- Final vendor layout
- Beer garden exact location and size
- Impact of construction on route/water station
- Race announcer confirmation
- Shoe manufacturer partnership

Next Steps

- All team members draft layout ideas once map received
- Define kids race logistics fully
- Volunteer recruitment push (schools, Oakfield Bats meeting)
- Race shirt design discussion with Brent
- Medal design finalization
- Social media content creation push
- Meeting with Kelly (Halton's Big Three coordinator) for photo

14. RACE DIFFERENTIATION STRATEGY

Key discussion points on making this race attractive:

- Appeal to shoe manufacturers through pro runner participation (8 slots: 8 male, 8 female)
- Cash prizes driving significant registration increase
- Part of "Halton's Big Three" race series
- Father's Day timing allows family festival atmosphere
- Well-run, professional event with proper signage throughout course
- Community-focused with local charity support

Meeting Duration: ~1.5 hours

Next Meeting: TBD after receiving city map

Notes on Transcription

*Auto-transcription attributed most dialogue to "Greg Kowalczyk" - actual speakers include all attendees.
Topics organized by subject area rather than individual speaker for clarity.*